12/2022

My name is Jeff Lacy better known as inmate [illegible] The Identification number given to me by the state of Idaho in the year 2003. I have remained in the system since the issuing of that number. I am a non violent offender that has repeatedly been sent back to prison whenever a new program was created, I relapsed or had officer interaction. Before I go into my explanation of how I feel our system is failing I first want to state. I am not innocent of the crimes I have committed. I take full responsibility for my actions and as the saying goes if you can't do the time don't do the crime.

Time in Idaho is relatively easy if you don't have anything in your past that makes you a target. Things like crimes against children, elderly, rape or the recent increase in snitching can have a tendency for you to be a target by other inmates. Time in this state, although relatively easy is lengthy. This system is literally bursting at the seams with non violent offenders pleuged by mandatory minimums or the unified sentencing act. The unified sentencing act was a relief designed to give lesser sentences. Instead it has been abused by judges to give everyone the maximum statue with a fixed term and indeterminate portion. So a large portion

of the inmate population get sentenced to the maximum penalty for a crime. Then on violations are subject to losing the time served on parole. So not only are inmates doing the maximum sentence for the crime, they are superceeding it for time that the Parole Commission forfiets. I litterally served 8 years on a 5 year sentence. A sentence ordered not to exceed 5 years.

The sentencing disparities are a seperate issue to the purpose of this paper. My purpose is to shed light on a rehabilitative practice that is being overlooked consistantly and the platform for it already exists. That crucial rehabilitative practice is education. Idaho statistically ranks very high as having the worst scores in the U.S. on standardized tests. To put it bluntly we produce the dumbest kids. Less educated communities produce more crime and substance abuse. Idaho has become a product of its environment with the excessive recidivism rate being driven by extremely long sentences, non violent drug offenders and lack of education.

I feel like I have a slight advantage over some at this stage in life because I am college educated and I did graduate high school. My legal troubles didn't surface until after I

graduated high school. From there addiction surfac
and I began the struggles of recidivism in the
system. I was however very driven upon release
more than once using opportunities to go to school
and obtained an associates degree. The struggle
and barriers laid out in front of me was so difficult
I am still amazed I was able to obtain a degree.
If I wouldn't have had my defiant nature and
accepted "No" or "you cannot" as an answer I
surely would have failed. But I compiled the limited
resources in the community and did what was necessary
to obtain a degree. One of the most difficult accomplis
of my life.

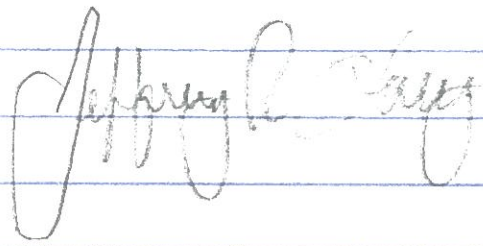
It is mind boggling to me that there is Khan
Academy on these tablets but access is limited
and it charges the user a per minute rate to
use the app. Why is this not offered at full access
and even promoted. It has recently been brought
to my attention that there is a 2nd chance
education grant being offered to inmates paid
for through FASFA. The information age of
technology and online education is becoming the
norm. Why not become an actual Judicial system
of correction instead of punishment. Utilize platforms
that are already free and make them available
to the masses so you could declare that a

Percentage of inmates that passed through the system were able to achieve an education at multiple levels. Starting from county jails, to prisons to work centers or community resource centers.

As I sit here today I am 26 months into an 82 month sentence. I am college educated but if I had it available I would have completed every course available to me on Khan Academy. Then as I enter into the state facility I would be even more prepared to take on the college level courses that are being experimented with currently.

The benifits of education are life altering. It opens doors for employment, self confidence, mental well being and even physical health. That makes a person more marketable to the world and that confidence would translate into less recidivism. The goal of institutions is correction.

JEFF LACY



Dated January 7th 2023